

SASWAT DAS

222 Rice Hall, 85 Engineer's Way, Charlottesville, VA 22903

☎ +1 434-760-7428 ✉ duh6ae@virginia.edu 🔗 saswatdas.com 🌐 github.com/SaswatD27

Responsible AI, (Differential) Privacy, Fairness, Security, Agentic LLMs

Education

University of Virginia (UVA)

Ph.D. in Computer Science

4.0 GPA

Aug. 2023 – Present

Charlottesville, Virginia

National Institute of Science Education and Research (NISER)

Integrated M.Sc. (BS + MS) in Mathematics (Minor in Computer Science)

8.39/10.0 CGPA; 9.44/10.0 in Computer Science

Jul. 2018 – May 2023

Bhubaneswar, India

Experience

Department of Computer Science, University of Virginia

Graduate Research Assistant (PhD)

- Mentor: Dr. Ferdinando Fioretto
- Focus Areas: Differential Privacy, Fairness, Responsible AI, Agentic LLMs

Aug. 2023 – Present

Charlottesville, VA

Pacific Northwest National Laboratory

PhD Intern

- Mentors: Dr. Joseph Manzano Franco, Dr. Andres Marquez
- Focus Areas: Data Privacy and Security, Agentic Safety

June 2026 – Present

Remote (from Charlottesville, VA)

Pacific Northwest National Laboratory

PhD Intern (Summer and Fall)

- Mentors: Dr. Joseph Manzano Franco, Dr. Andres Marquez
- Focus Areas: Data Privacy and Security

July 2025 – December 2025

Remote (from Charlottesville, VA)

EECS, Syracuse University

Visiting Research Scholar

- Mentor: Dr. Ferdinando Fioretto (now at UVA)
- Focus Areas: Differential Privacy, Fairness, Responsible AI

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Syracuse, NY

School of Computer Sciences, NISER

MS Research Scholar

- Mentor: Dr. Subhankar Mishra
- Focus Areas: Differential Privacy, Security, Responsible AI

Aug. 2021 – May 2023

Bhubaneswar, India

School of Computer Sciences, NISER

BS Summer and Winter Research Intern

- Mentor: Dr. Rishiraj Bhattacharyya (Now at the University of Birmingham)
- Focus Areas: Blockchain, P2P Networks, Cryptography, Zero-Knowledge Proofs

May 2019 – Jul. 2019, Dec 2019 – Jan. 2020

Bhubaneswar, India

Publications

Featured Publications

Colosseum: Auditing Collusion in Cooperative Multi-Agent Systems

2026

Mason Nakamura*, Abhinav Kumar*, **Saswat Das***, Sahar Abdelnabi,
Saaduddin Mahmud, Ferdinando Fioretto, Shlomo Zilberstein, Eugene Bagdasarian
Accepted at **NeurIPS 2026**; *arXiv:2602.15198*. *joint first authorship

Fairness Issues and Mitigations in (Differentially Private) Socio-demographic Data Processes

2025

Joonhyuk Ko, Juba Ziani, **Saswat Das**, Matt Williams, Ferdinando Fioretto
Accepted at **AAAI-25 (Oral Presentation)** and at **AAAI-PPAI-25 (Oral Presentation)**; *arXiv:2408.08471*

🏆 Low-rank Finetuning for LLMs is Inherently Unfair

2025

Saswat Das, Marco Romanelli, Cuong Tran, Zarreen Reza, Bhavya Kailkhura, Ferdinando Fioretto
CoLoRAI @ AAAI-25; Best Paper Award; *arXiv:2405.18572*

Disparate Impact on Group Accuracy of Linearization for Private Inference <i>Saswat Das</i> , Marco Romanelli, Ferdinando Fioretto Accepted at ICML-24 ; <i>arXiv:2402.03629</i>	2024
Finding ε and δ of Traditional Disclosure Control Systems <i>Saswat Das</i> , Keyu Zhu, Pascal van Hentenryck, Christine Task, Ferdinando Fioretto Accepted at AAAI-24 ; DOI:10.1609/aaai.v38i20.30204	2024

Workshop Publications

Beyond Jailbreaking: Auditing Contextual Privacy in LLM Agents <i>Saswat Das</i> , Jameson Sandler, Ferdinando Fioretto MTI-LLM Workshop @ NeurIPS-25; <i>arXiv:2506.10171</i>	2025
Conversational Privacy Attacks Against Agentic LLMs <i>Saswat Das</i> , Joseph Moretto, David Evans, Ferdinando Fioretto Accepted at PPAI-25 (Extended Abstract)	2025
Examining Deidentified Data Quality using NIST Datasets and Tools <i>Saswat Das</i> , Razane Tajeddine, Ferdinando Fioretto Accepted at NIST CRC 2023	2023
Fair Context-Aware Privacy Threat Modelling <i>Saswat Das</i> , Rakshit Naidu Accepted at WPTM at USENIX SOUPS 2022 ; <i>arXiv:2207.09750</i>	2023

Book Chapters

Advances in Differential Privacy and Differentially Private Machine Learning: A Survey <i>Saswat Das</i> , Subhankar Mishra Published in Information Technology Security (Springer Nature)	2023
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Preprints

NeuroFilter: Activation-Based Guardrails for Privacy-Conscious LLM Agents <i>Saswat Das</i> , Ferdinando Fioretto <i>arXiv:2601.14660</i>	2026
SEABench: Benchmarking Endogenous Misalignment In Self-Evolving Agents <i>Saswat Das</i> , Parvati Viswanathan, Daniel Donnelly, Chang Huang, Sahar Abdelnabi, Ferdinando Fioretto <i>arXiv:2609.35596</i>	2026

Selected Honours

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- **Best Paper Award** for “Low-rank Finetuning for LLMs is Inherently Unfair” at CoLoRAI Workshop at AAAI-25
 - **AAAI-25 - Oral Presentation** (Paper Title: Fairness Issues and Mitigations in (Differentially Private) Socio-demographic Data Processes)
 - **ICML-26 - Gold Reviewer Award** - Among the top 25% of Reviewers, awarded with complimentary registration
 - **NeurIPS-26 - Top Reviewer (8%) - Complimentary Registration** - Among the top 8% of Reviewers, awarded with complimentary registration
 - **AAAI - Student Travel Award** (2024 and 2025)
 - **UVA Computer Science Scholarship** (2023-24)
 - Selected for the **ELLIS Europe PhD Programme** (2023)
 - **DISHA Research Fellowship**, Department of Atomic Energy, Government of India (2018-2023)
 - Selected for **TIFR – Visiting Students’ Research Programme (VSRP)**, 2022 in Technology & Computer Science
 - **National Talent Search (NTS) Scholarship**, NCERT, India (2016)

Invited Talks

- **Google Privacy Seminar** (*May 2025*) - With Ferdinando Fioretto on “Auditing Privacy Leakage in LLM Agents”
- **TOC4Fairness** (*March 2025*) - With Joonhyuk Ko on “Fairness Issues and Mitigations in (Differentially Private) Socio-demographic Data Processes”
- **NIST CRC Workshop** (*December 2023*) - On “Examining Deidentified Data Quality using NIST Datasets and Tools”)

Students Advised

- Joonhyuk Ko - BS, University of Virginia - Next: PhD Student at Princeton, NSF GRFP Fellow, CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher (Finalist), Louis T. Raider Outstanding Undergraduate Researcher
- Kyle Briggs - BS, University of Virginia
- Lauren LaPorta - BS, University of Virginia
- Parvati Viswanathan - MS, University of Virginia
- Chang Huang - BS, University of Virginia - Next: MS at UIUC
- Aarav Lodha - BS, University of Virginia
- Eric Nguyen - BA, University of Virginia

Teaching

- CS 6501 - Responsible AI: Privacy, Fairness, and Robustness (UVA, Spring 2025)
- CS 4710 - Artificial Intelligence (UVA, Fall 2024)

Service/Reviewing

- **Workshop Workflow Co-Chair - AAAI-PPAI 2025**
- **Reviewer - JAIR (2025), NeurIPS 2024, ICML 2025, NeurIPS 2025, ICLR 2026, ICLR 2027, ICML 2026, NeurIPS 2026**
- **Program Committee Member - AAAI 2024, AAAI-PPAI 2024, AAAI 2025, AISec 2026**
- **Emergency Reviewer - AAMAS 2023, AAMAS 2025**
- **External Reviewer - National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) (2023)**

Other Associations

- **External Collaborator - Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory (2024 - 2025)**

Volunteering

Reading Group on Responsible Generative AI, University of Virginia **Oct. 2023 - Apr. 2024**
Organizer *at UVA*

- Organizing the reading group on responsible generative AI at the University of Virginia where members of various research groups that work on responsible AI/generative AI come together to discuss recent advancements and future directions of work.

CodeInPlace, Stanford University **Apr. 2021 - May 2021**
Section Leader/Teaching Assistant *Online; Organized by Stanford University*

- Taught coding to a section of students from a global pool of applicants using material from the first half of Stanford University’s popular course, CS106A.

School of Mathematical Sciences, NISER **Feb. 2021 - May 2021**
Department Mathematics Tutor *At NISER*

- Served as a mathematics tutor to freshmen in the spring of 2021 as part of an initiative by mathematics majors at the School of Mathematical Sciences, NISER.

Aveti Learning

Apr. 2020 - Sep 2022

Volunteer/Tutor/Mentor

Online

- Served as an online mathematics tutor and mentor to high school students in rural Eastern India to make quality education and college advice more accessible.

Avanti Fellows

Sep. 2018 - Aug. 2019

Section Leader/Teaching Assistant

Dhenkanal, India

- Served as a mentor and mathematics tutor to high school students at JNV Dhenkanal as part of the acclaimed Avanti Fellows programme.

Workshops and Summer/Winter Schools

AI-SCORE: The AI School for CS and OR Education

May-Jun 2024

Attendee; organized on the UMD College Park campus.

INFORMS/ACM SIGAI

Technion: Summer School on Computer & Cyber Security

September 2020

Attendee

Organized by Technion, Israel

IIT-D: Winter School on Theoretical Computer Science

December 2022

Accepted Attendee

Organized by IIT-Delhi

- Did not attend due to academic schedule conflicts.

USENIX SOUPS '23: Workshop on Privacy Threat Modeling

August 2022

Presenter/Attendee

Organized by MITRE at USENIX SOUPS 2023

- Presented a short paper on context-aware fair privacy threat modeling.

Leadership / Extracurricular

Undergraduate Committee of the School

Dec. 2020 - Dec. 2022

Student Representative

School of Mathematical Sciences, NISER

- Served as one of two student representatives to the Undergraduate Committee of the School (UGCS) of Mathematical Sciences, NISER. Helped professors design and develop the academic course structure, pedagogy, and evaluation schemes of the undergraduate program.

Inventa Magazine

July 2021 - Dec. 2021

Editor

IISERs, NISER, CeBS, and IISc (India)

- Worked on the editorial board for Inventa, an annual national science outreach magazine published jointly by the premier public research institutes of India: NISER, CeBS, IISc, and the IISERs.

Quizone (Campus Quiz Club), NISER

May. 2019 - Nov. 2021

President

NISER

- Served as the president of Quizone, the quiz club of NISER, HBNI, for two consecutive terms.

Cultural Committee, NISER

Aug. 2019 - Nov. 2021

Editor

NISER

- Served as a member of the cultural committee of NISER, which is responsible for planning and organising cultural events in the college.

Delhi Public School Kalinga

Sep. 2016 - July 2018

Head Boy (Students' Council President)

Odisha, India

- Served as the Head Boy (2017-18) and Vice Head Boy (2016-17) of Delhi Public School Kalinga, presiding over the students' council, organising events, and looking after the welfare and interests of the students of the school.

Skills (Not Exhaustive)

Programming/Scripting Languages: Python, R, C++, HTML/CSS, SQL, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Developer Tools: VS Code, SLURM, AWS Cloud, R Studio, etc.

Selected Libraries: Opacus, OpenDP/SmartNoise, PyTorch, HuggingFace Transformers, vLLM, Textgrad, Captum, sdcMicro + other common libraries

Languages: English, Hindi, Odia, (familiarity with) French